

Fund Summary

Portfolio Manager: Bryan Kazuya Mori
Inception: June 2024
Education and Experience:
 B.S. Cornell University, 2009
 Associate - Ichigo Asset Management, 2012-2018
 Research Analyst - King Street Capital Management, 2019-2020
 Consultant - ApaH Capital Management, 2021

Investment Strategy

Begonia Capital is a unique engagement fund focusing on Japanese public equities primarily in the mid to small cap range. Japan is finally getting recognition from the investment community as a viable market to capture shareholder returns after decades of being an afterthought. We strive to identify the best opportunities to invest in outstanding businesses trading at attractive valuations with management open to positive changes.

Performance Summary

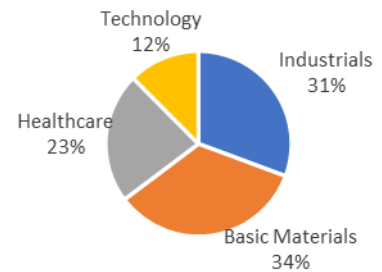
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	YTD	Since Inception
2024						+1.1%	+1.0%	-2.9%	+0.9%	+3.5%	+1.9%	+2.9%	+8.6%	+8.6%
2025	-2.0%	-3.4%	+0.7%	-0.3%	+5.0%	+4.4%	+5.6%	-0.7%	+1.7%	-1.3%	+1.3%	+2.5%	+13.8%	+23.6%
2026	+1.3%	+5.5%	-9.5%	+1.9%	+2.9%								+1.3%	+25.2%

Update

Begonia Capital had a net return of +2.9% for the month of May. The market continues to rebound from the deep drawdown in March as investors deem the tensions in the Middle East to be calming down.

In February, we mentioned that 2026 is a big sporting year for the Japanese audience with the Winter Olympics, World Baseball Classic and the World Cup. What wasn't mentioned was the Naoya Inoue and Juntō Nakatani boxing match that was held on May 2 at the Tokyo Dome. A match that had been in discussion for quite some time finally came to fruition and the match was advertised as being "The Day – The day that will eventually be called legendary." 2 boxers that came in with identical 32-0 undefeated records and ranked by The Ring magazine as Pound for Pound #2 and #6 in the world. Having a Japanese boxer in the top 10 has happened before but it is the first time that there has been 2 in the top 10 at the same time. Those 2 were going to face off and the crowd showed up for it. A sold-out crowd of 55 thousand attended with gate revenue estimated to be in the range of JPY 4-5 billion (more than \$30 million). There were an estimated 1 million more viewers watching on streams. The match would go the full 12 rounds with scenes of the 2 boxers smiling out of respect for each other. It would ultimately conclude with a unanimous decision to Naoya Inoue. His ranking would climb to the top to #1 in the world which he held the distinction of 2 years ago making it the 3rd time he becomes #1 while Nakatani dropped a spot to #7. After this exciting bout, Japan's World Cup National Team roster was released so the sports excitement continues on. Disappointingly, Japan will be without stars Kaoru Mitoma and Takumi Minamino (and it would be announced on a later date that Wataru Endo will also be out) due to injury. From being ranked in the 50s in the mid-2010s, they are now ranked 18 and have made tremendous strides over the past decade with many of their players now playing in Europe. A country that is supposed to have an aging and declining population is seemingly churning out more quality players in the sporting world – arguably the best baseball player in Shohei Ohtani, the # 1 ranked boxer in Naoya Inoue and an ever-improving soccer/football program. There is a lot of excitement around the team and its future. Japan has never gotten past Round of 16 in the World Cup and have their work cut out for them but people will be paying attention in Japan.

Sector Breakdown



Our 2nd largest position announced that net profit grew more than 20% YoY and a 5 yen increase in dividends. Our 5th largest position concluded a difficult fiscal year but announced that they see a light at the end of the tunnel and a forecast for a significant V shaped recovery along with a dividend increase. Our 6th largest position announced that they are turning the corner with positive operating profits after some temporary losses from heavy investment. They also announced that they will be revamping their management strategy plans – Begonia discussed a need to communicate this better to the market with the CFO which they seem to be taking to heart. Begonia will be speaking with them again in the coming weeks.

Thank you for your interest and support!

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